Annex: MMSU SDG 15 policies in force before 2025

Reference only. Not part of the 2025 evidence set.

These policies and appointments predate 2025. THE accepts policies that are in place, so the policy questions (15.3.1, 15.3.3, 15.4.2, 15.4.3) may draw on them; they are kept separate because this compilation retains only 2025 accomplishments.

MMSU's Commitment

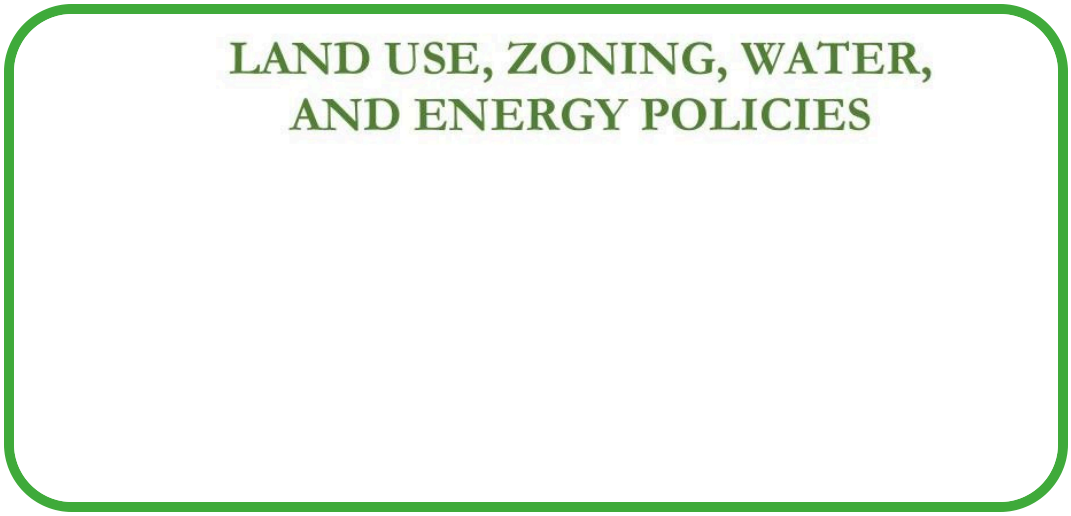
Take an active role in protecting and promoting sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, responsible land use, and biodiversity conservation.

SDG 15.3.1 · Sustainable use, conservation and restoration of land (policy, 2021)

Pre-2025 policy in force; reference only.

Evidence year: 2025 (calendar year)

MMSU Land Use Policy Commits the University to Conserve and Restore Its Lands


LAND USE, ZONING, WATER,
AND ENERGY POLICIES

Document: MMSU Land Use, Zoning, Water and Energy Policies (Sirmata 2040 LUDIP, 2021), Land Use Policy, page 1.

MMSU's Land Use, Zoning, Water and Energy Policies, adopted as part of Sirmata 2040, the university's Land Use Development and Infrastructure Plan prepared in 2021 under Republic Act 11396, govern the conservation, restoration and sustainable use of all university lands across its campuses.

Under Policy 1.3, the allocation and use of university lands "shall aim to maintain, protect, conserve, restore, and enhance the integrity of the land itself, the environment and ecological balance in all its campuses." Policy 7.1 requires decisions to be based on valid and reliable science, especially for any intent to alter or convert the natural state of any piece of university land, and Policy 10.2 gives fragile lands and protected areas special management "to protect, conserve, enrich, rehabilitate, and or sustain them."

The zoning policy sets aside Protected Land as a distinct zone; under Policy 9.1, "protected landholdings of the university shall be conserved, preserved and to be excluded from any form of alteration except as may be permitted by operation of law." The MMSU Forest Reserve is

maintained as a no-build zone, and Policy 4.3 requires the university to regularly review, update and promptly communicate its land-use policies.

Source

- MMSU, Land Use, Zoning, Water and Energy Policies (Sirmata 2040 LUDIP, 2021) https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/resources/19uycXrgcO_iXPdPpMQwdCRxmoD1U5i60/view
- MMSU, Planning and Development on Local Biodiversity (SDG 15 evidence page) https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/resources/1tbtCaZa6Uh7ieu4epmz35VJ9jrRQGlPi/data



MMSU's Commitment

Take an active role in protecting and promoting sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, responsible land use, and biodiversity conservation.

SDG 15.3.3 · Local biodiversity included in planning (Sirmata 2040, 2021)

Pre-2025 plan in force; reference only.

Evidence year: 2025 (calendar year)

Sirmata 2040: Planning MMSU's Campuses and Reserve Lands for Two Decades

Protected Land

Principle 9. Protection, conservation and preservation

Policy 9.1 Protected landholdings of the university shall be conserved, preserved and to be excluded from any form of alteration except as may be permitted by operation of law.

Document: MMSU Zoning Policy, Protected Land (Principle 9, Policy 9.1), Sirmata 2040 LUDIP.

Sirmata 2040, MMSU's Land Use Development and Infrastructure Plan (LUDIP), is the university's 20-year guide for managing its land resources and infrastructure. Prepared under Republic Act 11396, which requires state universities and colleges to have a LUDIP, and supported by a Php 2 million grant from the Commission on Higher Education (CHED), the plan covers the future land use of the MMSU campuses and the university's reserve areas in Nagbacsan, Payao, Lubbot and Sarnap, City of Batac, including the forest reserves where MMSU's forestry and agroforestry research is set up.

Local biodiversity is built into the plan's development rules. The zoning plan sets aside Protected Land, which "shall be conserved, preserved and to be excluded from any form of alteration except as may be permitted by operation of law" (Policy 9.1), and the MMSU Forest Reserve is kept as a no-build zone. Before any land is altered or converted, the plan requires a science-based assessment of its natural suitability and carrying capacity (Policies 7.1, 10.1 and 11.1).

The plan was developed through stakeholder consultations, sectoral studies and campus planning workshops, and was endorsed by the CHED Technical Working Group after validation visits to the campuses.

Source

- MMSU, Land Use, Zoning, Water and Energy Policies (Sirmata 2040 LUDIP, 2021) https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/resources/19uycXrgcO_iXPdPpMQwdCRxmoD1U5i60/view
- MMSU, Planning and Development on Local Biodiversity (SDG 15 evidence page) https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/resources/1tbtCaZa6Uh7ieu4epmz35VJ9jrRQGlPi/data
- MMSU News, “CHED TWG OKs MMSU Sirmata 2040” https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/ched-twg-oks-mmsu-sirmata-2040
- MMSU News, “MMSU gets Php 2 M for LUDIP project” https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-gets-php-2-m-for-ludip-project



MMSU's Commitment

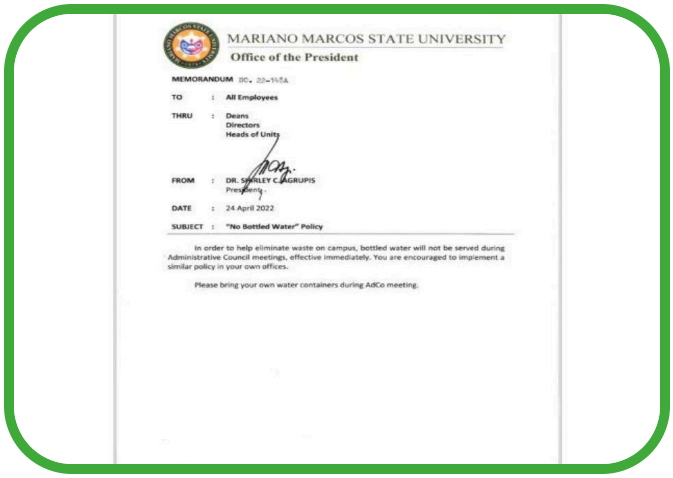
Take an active role in protecting and promoting sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, responsible land use, and biodiversity conservation.

SDG 15.4.2 · Plastic waste reduction policies (2009–2023)

Pre-2025 policies in force; reference only.

Evidence year: 2025 (calendar year)

MMSU Policies Eliminate Styrofoam and Reduce Plastic Waste on Campus



MARIANO MARCOS STATE UNIVERSITY
Office of the President

MEMORANDUM

TO : All Employees

THRU : Deans
Directors
Heads of Units

FROM : DR. SHIRLEY C. AGRUPIS
President

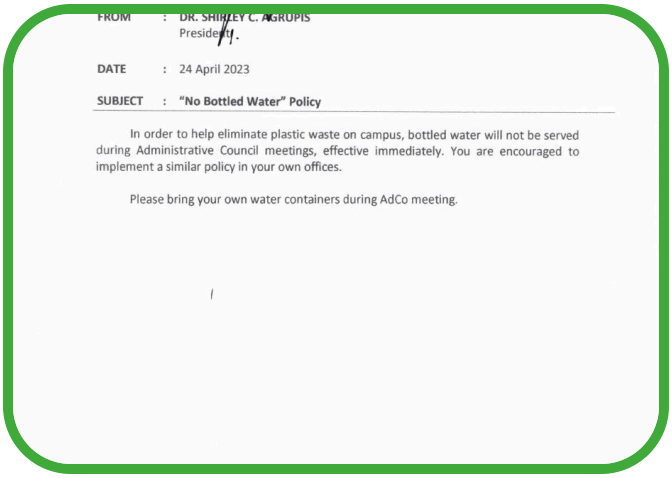
DATE : 24 April 2022

SUBJECT : "No Bottled Water" Policy

In order to help eliminate waste on campus, bottled water will not be served during Administrative Council meetings, effective immediately. You are encouraged to implement a similar policy in your own offices.

Please bring your own water containers during AdCo meeting.

Document: Office of the President Memorandum No. 22-148A, "No Bottled Water" Policy, 24 April 2022.



FROM : DR. SHIRLEY C. AGRUPIS
President

DATE : 24 April 2023

SUBJECT : "No Bottled Water" Policy

In order to help eliminate plastic waste on campus, bottled water will not be served during Administrative Council meetings, effective immediately. You are encouraged to implement a similar policy in your own offices.

Please bring your own water containers during AdCo meeting.

Document: Office of the President Memorandum No. 23-189, "No Bottled Water" Policy, 24 April 2023.

MMSU reduces plastic waste under its Integrated Waste Management Program, approved by the Board of Regents in 2009 and amended in 2015, and its revised Integrated Pollution and Waste Management Program. The program prohibits Styrofoam for serving or packing food in the university Food Service Unit and limits the use of plastics, and a policy promulgated on February 11, 2016 eliminates Styrofoam and plastic as secondary packaging materials in favour of paper bags, cartons, eco-bags and reusable containers. The University Waste Management Committee develops, reviews and monitors these rules, and the food service unit requires customers dining out to bring their own food containers.

The Office of the President reissues the "No Bottled Water" Policy each year: Memorandum No. 22-148A of April 24, 2022 and Memorandum No. 23-189 of April 24, 2023 stop the serving of bottled water at Administrative Council meetings, ask members to bring their own water containers, and encourage all offices to adopt the same policy. In October 2024 the College of Agriculture, Food and Sustainable Development banned plastic bottled water in its auxiliary

buildings, and on July 1, 2025 MMSU signed a memorandum of commitment with DENR-EMB Region I for the Regional Ecology Center to support solid waste management under Republic Act 9003 and the Extended Producer Responsibility Act (Republic Act 11898).

Source

- MMSU, Plastic Waste Management (SDG 15 evidence page) https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/resources/1NU-Qda9KG0J-PIOgKZwPKC4h_TU05zcm/data
- MMSU, Revised Integrated Pollution and Waste Management Program https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/resources/1fNUCZwyOozOKO27L2Bm6pNN-P_cJNpLd/view
- MMSU Office of the President, “No Bottled Water” Policy, Memorandum No. 22-148A (2022) and No. 23-189 (2023) https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/resources/1LbnK8yYkg-47ChbXyT0r8VQ9eBGuMxRx/data
- MMSU News, “MMSU CAFSD rolls out waste and pollution management program,” 15 October 2024 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-cafsd-rolls-out-waste-and-pollution-management-program
- MMSU News, “MMSU commits to ecological solid waste management in Region I,” 2 July 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-commits-to-ecological-solid-waste-management-in-region-i



MMSU's Commitment

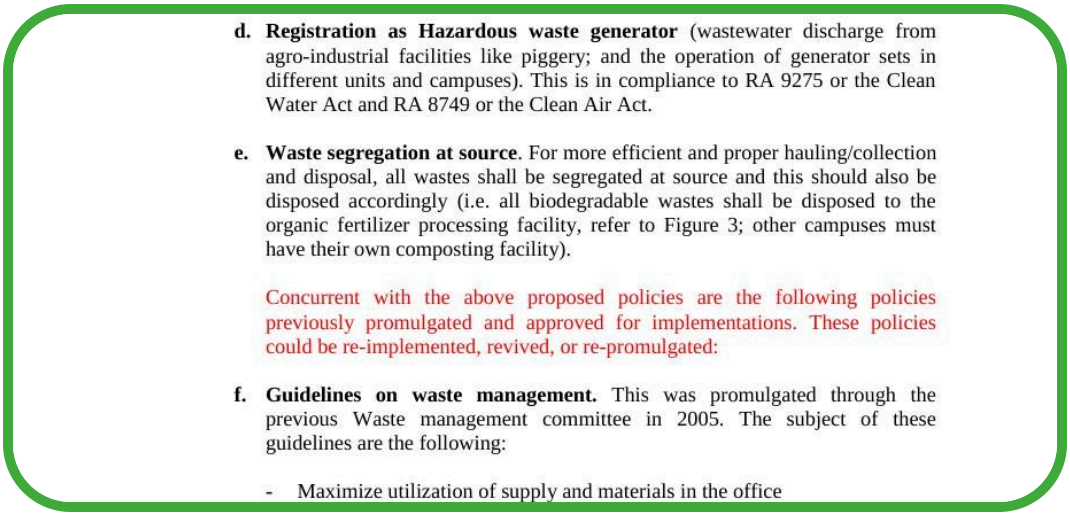
Take an active role in protecting and promoting sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, responsible land use, and biodiversity conservation.

SDG 15.4.3 · Hazardous waste disposal (IPWMP, revised 2020)

Pre-2025 policy in force; reference only.

Evidence year: 2025 (calendar year)

Hazardous Waste Disposal under MMSU's Integrated Pollution and Waste Management Program



d. **Registration as Hazardous waste generator** (wastewater discharge from agro-industrial facilities like piggery; and the operation of generator sets in different units and campuses). This is in compliance to RA 9275 or the Clean Water Act and RA 8749 or the Clean Air Act.

e. **Waste segregation at source**. For more efficient and proper hauling/collection and disposal, all wastes shall be segregated at source and this should also be disposed accordingly (i.e. all biodegradable wastes shall be disposed to the organic fertilizer processing facility, refer to Figure 3; other campuses must have their own composting facility).

Concurrent with the above proposed policies are the following policies previously promulgated and approved for implementations. These policies could be re-implemented, revived, or re-promulgated:

f. **Guidelines on waste management.** This was promulgated through the previous Waste management committee in 2005. The subject of these guidelines are the following:

- Maximize utilization of supply and materials in the office

Document: Revised Integrated Pollution and Waste Management Program of MMSU, provisions on PCB and hazardous waste storage and registration.

MMSU's Integrated Waste Management Program was revised in 2020 into the Integrated Pollution and Waste Management Program (IPWMP), implemented by the Pollution Control Unit and the General Services directorate, to cover hazardous materials. The IPWMP assigns focal persons for hazardous wastes (chemical and related wastes), air and water pollution, solid wastes, and PCBs and related industrial wastes, and requires the waste coordinators of every unit to store and label generated hazardous wastes properly before collection.

The program establishes centralized, separate storage facilities for polychlorinated biphenyls (PCBs) and other hazardous or toxic wastes collected from the campuses, where the wastes are kept for up to one year before disposal through a DENR-accredited transport, storage and disposal facility, in compliance with Republic Act 6969 and its storage guidelines. Units that

generate hazardous waste are registered as hazardous waste generators, and the university coordinates with the Environmental Management Bureau of DENR for final collection and disposal.

Source

- MMSU, Hazardous Waste Disposal (SDG 15 evidence page) https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/resources/1jo6-3cVqxRAIlllIxEhnSCgyT5ef5LGOW/data
- MMSU, Revised Integrated Pollution and Waste Management Program https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/resources/1fNUCZwyOozOKO27L2Bm6pNN-P_cJNpLd/view

MMSU's Commitment

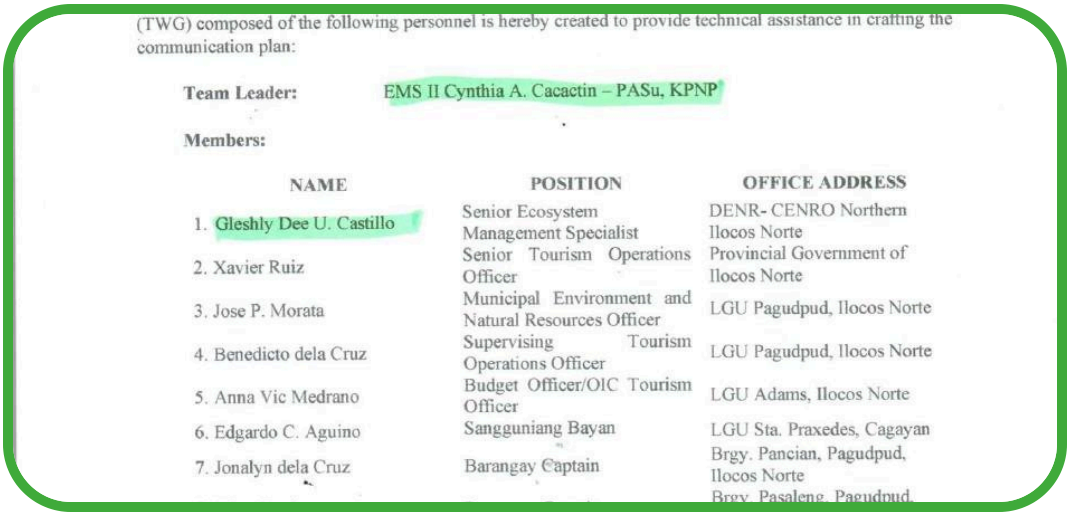
Take an active role in protecting and promoting sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, responsible land use, and biodiversity conservation.

SDG 15.3.5 · Kalbario-Patapat Natural Park TWG (2023)

Pre-2025 appointment; reference only.

Evidence year: 2025 (calendar year)

MMSU Expert Serves on the Kalbario-Patapat Natural Park Technical Working Group



(TWG) composed of the following personnel is hereby created to provide technical assistance in crafting the communication plan:

Team Leader: EMS II Cynthia A. Cacactin – PASu, KPNP

Members:

NAME	POSITION	OFFICE ADDRESS
1. Gleshly Dee U. Castillo	Senior Ecosystem Management Specialist	DENR- CENRO Northern Ilocos Norte
2. Xavier Ruiz	Senior Tourism Operations Officer	Provincial Government of Ilocos Norte
3. Jose P. Morata	Municipal Environment and Natural Resources Officer	LGU Pagudpud, Ilocos Norte
4. Benedicto dela Cruz	Supervising Tourism Operations Officer	LGU Pagudpud, Ilocos Norte
5. Anna Vic Medrano	Budget Officer/OIC Tourism Officer	LGU Adams, Ilocos Norte
6. Edgardo C. Aguino	Sangguniang Bayan	LGU Sta. Praxedes, Cagayan
7. Jonalyn dela Cruz	Barangay Captain	Brgy. Pancian, Pagudpud, Ilocos Norte
		Brgy. Pasaleng, Pagudpud

Document: DENR-PENRO Ilocos Norte Special Order No. 2023-024 (29 March 2023) naming Dr. Arlene L. Gonzales of MMSU to the KPNP Technical Working Group.

Through DENR-PENRO Ilocos Norte Special Order No. 2023-024, dated March 29, 2023, Dr. Arlene L. Gonzales of MMSU was named a member of the Technical Working Group that prepares the Communication Plan of the Kalbario-Patapat Natural Park (KPNP), a protected area in Ilocos Norte. The group, led by the KPNP Protected Area Superintendent, brings together DENR offices, the Provincial Government of Ilocos Norte, the LGUs of Pagudpud and Adams in Ilocos Norte and Sta. Praxedes in Cagayan, barangay officials and Northwestern University.

The Communication Plan supports the goal of the KPNP Protected Area Management Plan to adopt and carry out effective information and education campaigns for biological diversity conservation and for the promotion of the protected area as a major ecotourism destination.

Source

- DENR-PENRO Ilocos Norte Special Order No. 2023-024, 29 March 2023 (MMSU SDG 15 page) https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/resources/1TCpM-DxbkgfOh4QGwlfVr8QavCchKWKu/data